

Hellbender

Player-facing description

Hellbender: The old Hellbender is the story people tell when the ground hears too much: an ancient spidermander presence said to sense movement through root, soil, and fear.

Public role

Legendary ancient spidermander

Handout text

Player-safe note: The old Hellbender is the story people tell when the ground hears too much: an ancient spidermander presence said to sense movement through root, soil, and fear.

Raw source

- Type: creature
- Role: Legendary ancient spidermander
- Summary: The old Hellbender is the story people tell when the ground hears too much: an ancient spidermander presence said to sense movement through root, soil, and fear.
- Tags: sablewood-lore ambient legend underroot source-page-5
- Aliases: Hellbender ancient spidermander
- Connections: Root's Hollow Underroot Spidermanders
- Inventory: Keep it as legend, tremor, shed scale, or future-campaign awe unless Kyle calls for a direct encounter.
- Loot: Search yields context first: spoor, warning marks, tool scratches, route signs, or local testimony unless a scene names treasure.
- Image Fallback: type-icon
- Source Pages: Sablewood PDF p. 5
- Name: Hellbender
- Id: hellbender
- Meta: Creature / Animal CREATURE assets/icons/creature.png entity-creature #78a65f04 Creatures entities creature
- Related: Root's Hollow Spidermanders Underroot
- Image Prompt: Private table TTRPG story atlas asset for Hellbender, Creature / Animal. Role: Legendary ancient spidermander. Summary: The old Hellbender is the story people tell when the ground hears too much: an ancient spidermander presence said to sense movement through root, soil, and fear.. Cinematic fantasy concept art, readable silhouette, no visible text, no UI, no watermark. Do not include the Strixwolf Mother, strixwolf pups, wolves, owlbeats, or animal companions.
- Personality: The old Hellbender is the story people tell when the ground hears too much: an ancient spidermander presence said to sense movement through root, soil, and fear.; show instinct first through distance, posture, scent, and how the creature protects what is close to it.

- Wants: Reach safety on its own terms and communicate danger through behavior before the party turns the moment into combat.
- Fears: Being surrounded, misread as a monster, or driven toward Root's Hollow, Underroot, Spidermanders by noise and haste.
- Secrets: No forced reveal. Let this entity disclose truth through scene context and player attention.
- Body Language: Moves from protection, not malice. Reacts to posture, volume, and distance more than words.
- Sample Dialogue: The old Hellbender is the story people tell when the ground hears too much: an ancient spidermander presence said to sense movement through root, soil, and fear.
- Equipment: Keep it as legend, tremor, shed scale, or future-campaign awe unless Kyle calls for a direct encounter.
- Search Or Loot: Search yields context first: spoor, warning marks, tool scratches, route signs, or local testimony unless a scene names treasure.
- Gm Use: Use as a moral encounter. Reward restraint and observation without forcing a pet or mascot outcome.
- Future Hooks: Bring back as an echo if players made a strong choice involving this entity.
- Robust: Hellbender: The old Hellbender is the story people tell when the ground hears too much: an ancient spidermander presence said to sense movement through root, soil, and fear. No forced reveal. Let this entity disclose truth through scene context and player attention. Give one concrete visual, one sound or texture, and one sign of who has used or neglected it. Reach safety on its own terms and communicate danger through behavior before the party turns the moment into combat. Being surrounded, misread as a monster, or driven toward Root's Hollow, Underroot, Spidermanders by noise and haste. Use as a moral encounter. Reward restraint and observation without forcing a pet or mascot outcome. Knowledge / Instinct / Presence as fits the table 15 Learn the clean fact about Hellbender and one deeper connection. Learn the useful fact and gain a follow-up question. Learn the fact, but reveal who notices, who is endangered, or what timer advances. Miss the full answer, but gain a sensory clue or safe next step. Misread the pressure and invite a GM move tied to cost, custody, or danger. Spend Fear to reveal the system behind the object, move a threat closer, or make a choice more costly...
- Pronunciation: HEL-ben-der
- Short Pronunciation: HEL-ben-der
- Image: assets/creature-images/hellbender/portrait_base.png
- Image Asset Status: creature_images
- Visual Gallery: primary Primary wiki image primary assets/creature-images/hellbender/portrait_base.png Hellbender primary wiki image visual. Hellbender: Primary wiki image. creature_images True True

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